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Collective Experience

Episode 17: Murder Party

Written by

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Final Draft

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INTRO

NARRATOR (spookily)

The Amethyst Collective Presents:

Pause.

Collective Experience:

Pause.

Episode 17: Murder party.

PRE-STATEMENT

Ashley starts the tape.

ASHLEY V. E. (panting)

Amadeus, please, listen to me. Why would I ever lie to you on what happened?

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. I believe you, it just sounds a little... fantastical, is all.

ASHLEY V. E. Ugh, forget it. I'll be back later.

Footsteps as she leaves the room, and slams the door. Amadeus sighs.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. (to himself)

Christ, I need to stop being so harsh with it.

The door creaks open.

ASHLEY V. E. I...

She pauses, then sighs.

ASHLEY V. E. I'm headed out for a coffee. Is there something you want from the cafe?

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Just a coffee would be delightful, thank you very much. Do you remember my order?

ASHLEY V. E. (Sarcastic/playful)

You think that I, Ashley Venetia Ellsworth, Archival Visionary, Would delete the coffee order of my only friend from my notes app? Gosh, Amadeus, I didn't know you thought so low of me!

Amadeus chuckles.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. How long do you think you'll be out?

ASHLEY V. E. I'll be back in but a jiffy, Amadeus, so you can sit that posh Victorian arse of yours down and wait patiently.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Ha! Get back safely, now, Ashley.

ASHLEY V. E. Yes, boss! See ya!

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. See-

The door slams.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. You...

Amadeus sighs.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Well, I have this document here, may as well make an audio transcript.

STATEMENT

BACKGROUND FADES OUT, AUDIO QUALITY/EQ GETS BETTER

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Statement of Hypatius Trivizas in an unsent letter to his brother, Mikalose.
(pronounced mih-Ka-lohs-eh)

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Statement begins.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. (nominally more Greek sounding, and a little gruff)

My dear brother Mikalose; whatever the cops say, I need you to believe that it was not me who killed them. I did not kill them. I implore you to burn this letter after you read it.

I learned about them through a bulletin board flyer. "We have a party to host and we need new people," they said, "come for a bloody good time," they said. I should have seen the fucking signs.

The party was listed as being a week from then, but it was impossible to get it out of my mind. I kept ruminating on it, There was something subtly *wrong* about it, but I couldn't really place it. I think there were flecks of blood on the flyer? They didn't look like they were accidental, it almost seemed to complement the design of it, yeah? You get what I'm saying.

I couldn't get the suspicion out of my mind, so I made the brash decision to surveille the place. I'm not even sure how I remembered the address, I wrote nothing down, and I took no photos.

The place was well out of the way, like, significantly so, about half hour past the second gate. The place itself was unremarkable, a relicish manor out in the swamp, nothing new. But the place was cold, even in Infernal territory. The air was moist, and smelled faintly sanguine. The whole place seemed to be choked in a red light, but the sun was white as ever.

By this point, somehow, I still wasn't even spooked, so I walked up a bit closer. All of the windows were smashed, but not like an abandoned building, most of the glass was on the outside, some had dried blood on edges, some even a flake of severed skin. This is the point I decided to head home. But you know me better than anyone, brother, so you know what didn't happen.

I went to go check the lock. I don't know why, I knew it would be locked, but I did anyway. I begged my shaking legs to let me leave. My hand is a

little shaky, Mikalose, but that is just because of the bandages on my hands. I punched through one of the partially broken windows, the nearest one to the door, and went to unlock it. It glided up and open, as if ushering me inside. Hand dripping with blood, I clambered over the windowsill and tumbled inside. As expected, there was no glass inside, but even stranger, everything looked slightly different than it did from outside, as if it had refurbished itself from between when I first saw it and when I fell inside. Then there was a voice, echoing from an upstairs landing.

"Kirsch, you were right, that new flyer was quite effective. Welcome in, young man, are you here for the party?" There was an older man, dressed sharply in old fashioned clothing. I wasn't there for the party, I just wanted to check the place out, I would be leaving immediately, I tried to reply. But that wasn't what tumbled from my lips.

"Yes, I am, I've been anxious to participate." In hindsight, I think this was where I realised my will was not my own, but I don't think I ever did. "Well then, come along, the party has already started!" If you are astute, brother, and I know you are, you will remember that the party was dated for a week from then. At the time, however, I did not notice, I merely followed them along, pulled by a metaphorical leash. I was dragged into a colossal ballroom, filled with high spirits, gallivanting music, an almost choking sanguine smell, masked men and women dancing together in a waltz across a linoleum floor, and a few unmasked scattered across the room, with expressions as if they were scared for their life, yet they kept waltzing, in an almost mechanical fashion. A few seemed to have bloody bites or two canine prick holes on

the sides of their necks, but at the time I paid it not notice, well, it's not like I could, regardless.

Then I noticed a pool of blood in the middle of the room, and in it, a body. At this point I believe their control over me snapped, and "let me go" tumbled out of my lips in a similar fashion. A deeper voice from the man I believe to be Kirsch replied with, "So soon? But we haven't had our fun yet," whilst pulling out a retractable scalpel. "Let me leave," I repeated, louder, almost begging. Everything around me stopped.

When I say it wasn't me who killed them, I suppose that wasn't exactly true, but it wasn't exactly false either. The frenzy I felt in that moment was unlike I believe that I am at all capable of, and the sheer carnage in my wake was unnatural.

The room broke out in complete and utter violence. The first to die were the unmasked ones, throats ripped out by the teeth of their dance partners, writhing in pain, lungs gurgling with pooling blood. Knives in guts and claws in eyes and screams in agony and anger filled the room and I was *compelled* to participate. I stole the scalpel of Kirsch and plunged it into the arteries in his neck, and on instinct drank some of the spurting, dripping blood. It tasted excellent.

I begged myself to run for the door, to try and leave and escape this carnage but I turned and ran toward the dance floor. My first victim there was a man in ill-fitting clothes and with a young demeanour. I plunged the scalpel up and into the ligaments into his shoulder, prying the arm out. In a few short cuts I was able to sever the arm, socket and all.

My next was a short, stout woman, covered in jewellery. I stabbed her

in the back, twelve times, through the ribs. Her white coat stained red, and she kept standing. She turned and lunged at me with gore stricken claws, but I plunged the blade into her heart, and back out, and in again, three more times. I could feel tears start to streak down my face. I tried to say "I'm sorry." I tried. I could feel my blood boil and my muscles ache in the frenzy. Most dancers were on the floor, either morbidly writhing and moaning, or dead. By this point I was able to autonomously move a few fingers with great effort, so I clawed my scalpel hand open, and it dropped onto my feet. I yowled, stumbled back into a table, and the trance was broken. I ran for the door, stumbled through, and collapsed onto the floor. Looking up, I saw that the room looked identical. No, not looked identical, not was identical, it was the same room. I stumbled through the door and out of the door at the opposite side.

"There are only two ways out of here, and only one of them has you leave alive," the man who greeted me at the door said. I knew what he meant. What I had to do. Four more people, four more grizzly deaths from my hands and beneath my feet. My mind began to haze as the violence regained control of me. Ears torn from heads, fingernails from hands, viscera from stomachs. After the snap of the last one's neck, a bell chimed, and everything rushed back to me. I was knee deep in corpses. I was the only one left. I collapsed onto the ground, and lay there for upwards of an hour, feeling the madness seep from my wounds, feeling the blood slowly stain my clothes, feeling the smell choke my senses.

I then stood up, and walked out, empty. No thoughts were had, no observations made, just walking one step after another back to my house. The front door was unlocked, and the marshland it inhabited was calm. I

took care not to be seen walking home, though, by instinct alone, darting through alleyways, climbing over buildings, hopping into my house through the back window I always keep unlocked for times like these. I went to my room, turned on the lamp, locked the door, and shut the curtains. Before this point, I hadn't thought to check what time it was, and my clock said it was the date of the party. I then bandaged up my hands, picked up my pen and paper and began writing this very letter before you. Brother, please believe me that I did not wish to do any of this, yet I still am not sure if i was acting against my will or just attempting to rationalise my actions. I-

POST-STATEMENT

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. (In normal voice)

Statement ends. The rest of the letter was obscured by a large bloodstain. The letter was found beneath the corpse of one Hypatius Trivizas, who appeared to have been stabbed in the heart with his very own quill, though no blood spilled onto the quill. It appears that the wound was made postmortem, as the man had a fast acting blood-borne poison, and a wound hidden under his clothing in his back. He-

Ashley knocks at the door.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Ah, Ashley, come in!

ASHLEY V. E. (Jokingly)

One flat white with one sugar and honey for a dashing sir Amadeus?

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. You are so kind, thank you Ashley.

ASHLEY V. E. Good thinking recording that statement whilst I was out. Quite the grim one, innit?

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. They hardly ever aren't grim.

ASHLEY V. E. True, that.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Did you enjoy your time at the cafe?

ASHLEY V. E. I suppose. Can't complain, really. Well, I got a bit of my "personal readings" done, if you catch my drift, so it wasn't all mediocre. (Coyly)

Do you wanna come join me for my dungeons and dragons game tonight? We're down a member and I'm sure they'd love to meet yer.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. (tonally blushing)

I would love to, Ashley, thank you. Oh, it appears I've left the tape running. Well, th(en)-

Amadeus clicks off the tape, then clicks it back on.

SIR M. AMADEUS ESQ. Post statement continues.

His descriptions of the situation seem accurate, at least to him, but I would pass this off as a bad dream if not for those wounds, and knowing what I know now. Just a few weeks prior I know with certainty I would have dismissed this. Though, I suppose, this does somewhat wrap up that "Vampire manor" thread I had. Recording ends.

Amadeus clicks the tape back off.

OUTRO

NARRATOR This episode was directed and produced by Theia Valerian, with executive producers Alabaster Artichoke, Nyxis Audria, Nathaniel Quotient, and Adelard Valerian. Ashley Ellsworth was played by Ashley Valerian, and Sir Amadeus was played by Aelfriec Valerian. Vocal edit was performed by Nyxis Audria, with additional editing by Theia Valerian and Nathaniel Quotient. Please support us on Patreon at patreon.com/macguffinarchives, that's

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